

NovaTech Solutions

Employee Handbook

2025 Edition | For Internal Use Only

1. Welcome to NovaTech Solutions

Welcome aboard! NovaTech Solutions is a leading technology services firm headquartered in Dubai, with regional offices in Riyadh, Abu Dhabi, and Cairo. We deliver enterprise IT solutions, cloud services, and digital transformation consulting to clients across the GCC and MENA region.

This handbook serves as your guide to our culture, policies, and the resources available to you as an employee.

1.1 Our Mission & Values

- Innovation First — We embrace emerging technologies to solve complex business problems.
- Client Commitment — Our clients' success is our success.
- People Powered — Our team is our greatest asset.
- Integrity Always — We act with transparency, honesty, and accountability.

1.2 Company Structure

NovaTech operates across four business units: Cloud & Infrastructure, Digital Transformation, Cybersecurity, and Enterprise Applications. Each unit is led by a VP and reports to the Chief Operating Officer.

2. Working Hours & Attendance

Standard working hours are Sunday to Thursday, 9:00 AM – 6:00 PM GST, with a one-hour break. Friday and Saturday are official weekends as per UAE Labour Law.

2.1 Flexible Work Policy

- Employees may request flexible start times (8:00 AM – 10:00 AM) with manager approval.
- Remote work is permitted up to 2 days per week, subject to team and project requirements.
- All remote work requests must be logged in the HR portal (Workday) by the preceding Thursday.

2.2 Leave Entitlements

Leave Type	Days Per Year	Notes
Annual Leave	30 calendar days	Accrued from date of joining
Sick Leave	15 working days	Medical certificate required after 2 days
Emergency Leave	5 working days	Immediate family only
Maternity Leave	60 calendar days	Per UAE Federal Law No. 33 of 2021
Paternity Leave	5 working days	Within 30 days of child's birth

3. Code of Conduct

All NovaTech employees are expected to maintain the highest standards of professional behavior, in alignment with UAE Federal Decree-Law No. 33 of 2021 on the Regulation of Labour Relations.

3.1 Workplace Behavior

- Treat all colleagues, clients, and partners with respect and professionalism.
- Zero tolerance for discrimination, harassment, or bullying of any kind.
- Maintain confidentiality of all client data and proprietary company information.
- Conflicts of interest must be disclosed to your line manager immediately.

3.2 Digital & Communication Policy

- Company devices and email are for professional use. Limited personal use is permitted.
- Do not share login credentials or access company systems from unsecured networks.
- All external communications representing NovaTech must be reviewed by your manager.

4. IT Access & Tools

On your first day, the IT team will provision your accounts and equipment. The standard toolset at NovaTech includes:

4.1 Core Platforms

Tool	Purpose	Access Request
Microsoft 365	Email, Teams, Office apps	Auto-provisioned Day 1
Jira	Project & task management	Raise IT ticket
Confluence	Internal knowledge base	Raise IT ticket
Workday	HR portal — leaves, payroll	Auto-provisioned Day 1
Salesforce CRM	Client & pipeline management	Manager approval required
GitHub Enterprise	Code repositories	Team lead request

5. Benefits & Compensation

5.1 Salary & Payroll

- Salaries are processed on the 25th of each month via the UAE Wage Protection System (WPS).
- Payslips are accessible via Workday by the 27th of each month.
- Annual performance reviews take place in December; increments are effective from January.

5.2 Health Insurance

- All employees and their immediate dependents (spouse + up to 3 children) receive comprehensive health coverage through Daman Insurance.
- Coverage includes inpatient, outpatient, dental (basic), and optical (annual allowance AED 500).
- Insurance cards are issued within the first two weeks of joining.

5.3 Other Benefits

- Annual flight allowance: AED 3,000 for employees on expatriate packages.
- Professional development budget: AED 5,000 per year per employee for certifications and courses.
- Mobile allowance: AED 200/month for roles requiring field client interaction.

6. Expense Reimbursement

Business expenses incurred on behalf of NovaTech are reimbursable with manager approval and valid receipts. Reimbursements are processed within 10 working days of submission.

6.1 Expense Approval Thresholds

Expense Category	Limit (AED)	Approval Required From
Meals & Entertainment	Up to 500	Line Manager
Travel (Domestic)	Up to 2,000	Line Manager
Travel (International)	Up to 8,000	VP + Finance
Software / Subscriptions	Up to 1,000	IT Manager
Equipment Purchase	Above 1,000	CFO approval

To submit an expense: Log into Workday → My Expenses → New Expense Report → attach receipts → submit for approval.

7. Performance & Growth

7.1 Probation Period

All new employees undergo a 6-month probationary period. A formal mid-probation review is conducted at month 3, and a final evaluation at month 6 determines confirmation of employment.

7.2 KPIs & Goal Setting

- Goals are set within the first 30 days of joining, collaboratively with your line manager.
- Quarterly check-ins are held to review progress against KPIs.
- Year-end performance ratings follow a 5-point scale: Exceptional / Exceeds / Meets / Approaching / Does Not Meet.

8. HR Contacts & Escalation

Role	Contact	For Queries About
HR Business Partner	hr@novatech.ae	Policies, leaves, contracts
IT Helpdesk	ithelpdesk@novatech.ae	System access, equipment
Payroll Team	payroll@novatech.ae	Salary, WPS, payslips
L&D Manager	learning@novatech.ae	Training, certifications, PD budget

This handbook is reviewed annually. Last updated: January 2025. For the most current version, visit the HR section on Confluence.